PUBLIC TENDER

Tender number: 2025-0509

DESCRIPTION OF SERVICES

Redesign of the Website planetaryhealthcheck.org

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1. INITIAL SITUATION

1.1 Introduction of the Potsdam Institute for Climate Impact Research

The Potsdam Institute for Climate Impact Research e.V. (PIK), a research institute of the Gottfried Wilhelm Leibniz Science Association (Leibniz-Gemeinschaft), investigates scientifically and socially relevant issues in the fields of global and regional climate change, climate impacts and sustainable development. Researchers from the natural and social sciences work together to combine the latest insights into the Earth system with the assessment of climate risks and research into policy options. The scientific findings thus offer regional, national and international solutions for politics, business and civil society to shape a safe and just climate future. The most important methodological approaches at PIK are system and scenario analyses, quantitative and qualitative modeling as well as computer simulation and data integration. PIK publishes its scientific results after thorough internal and external peer review in leading international journals as well as in books and suitable digital formats. Through lectures, contributions to conferences and social media, interviews and various other dialog formats, PIK fosters professional exchange with politics, science and society.

1.2 Introduction of the Planetary Boundaries and the PBScience Lab

Planetary Boundaries are defined for the nine biophysical systems and processes that regulate the functioning of life support on Earth, and ultimately the stability and resilience of the Earth system. The scientifically defined boundary levels collectively define the safe operating space of the Earth system. Transgressing or overshooting one or more of the nine interconnected planetary boundaries leads to increasing risk, uncertainty, and ultimately a high-risk zone where destabilization of Earth's key systems can occur. Currently, we have transgressed at least six of the nine planetary boundaries, so monitoring them is more important than ever.

The Planetary Boundaries Science (PBScience) Lab was officially founded at PIK in 2024 and leads the production of the Planetary Health Check report, an annual report on the state of Earth's Health that highlights the latest science findings and updates the current state and risk level of each of the nine Planetary Boundaries. The report is authored and reviewed by a diverse international scientific community, and employs cutting-edge Earth system and tipping-point modelling, ambitious whole-Earth monitoring, and includes big data analytics with state-of-the-art methods. The long-term aim of the Lab is to make the observational data and modelled outcomes accessible to all, thereby driving positive change and bringing us back within the safe operating space.

1.3 Status Quo

The website planetaryhealthcheck.org, which is used by the PBScience Lab to present its annual Planetary Health Check Report and provide additional material for download, was launched on September 22, 2024 for the publication of the 2024 report. The website is currently hosted and maintained by a private service provider.

Since the publication of last year's report, relatively few changes have been made to the website. In addition to some pages that provide general information on the topic of planetary boundaries, there are sections that show the contents of the Planetary Health Check Report itself (e.g. images for download). The current layout of the website is optimized for only one report edition at a time. Originally, the maintenance and continuous updating of the website by selected members of the PBScience Lab was planned, but due to technical hurdles (e.g. restricted user access) this has so far only been implemented to a limited extent. The only regularly updated content are environment- and climate-related news delivered via the API of an environmental news organization in form of a news ticker in the footer of the landing page and under the tab “News”. While this is not directly related to the project or the topic of planetary boundaries, news shown under the “News” tab are sorted according to the different boundaries. There is currently no news section for the team or for research into planetary boundaries in general, but this would be desirable. The next edition of the report is due to be published on 24th September 2025 via the website, alongside supporting material such as the report summary, report figures, etc.

1.4 Vision

Our vision for a redesigned website is a professional, inviting, clearly laid out and modern look that creates excitement about the contents the visitor is about to discover without overwhelming them with information. At the same time, the design should reflect that the Planetary Health Check is the authoritative and reputable source of information on the comprehensive health of the planet. A flexible design that gives the members of our research team a certain amount of control over the content and layout is preferred, given the versatility of the topics covered in planetary boundaries research and the new and innovative methods pioneered by our team members.

We envision a layout that works well with different display shapes and sizes (responsive design) and that can accommodate special needs, such as color blindness, screen narrator, etc. Moreover, the website should be set up to be easily translatable into different languages.

Throughout the website, site visitors should gauge that the Planetary Boundary Framework has global relevance to all people living on Earth, since it is used to measure the “health” of the biophysical systems that sustain life on Earth. Advancing the Framework is a global endeavor, and contributions from around the globe are welcome, and required, to measure the state of our planet as accurately as possible. The website, at least particular portions of it, will be frequently updated to incentivize visitors to come back. The concept and layout of the website, while built around an annual report, should create an experience worthwhile to visitors all year round.

2. GOALS

We are looking for a service provider that can deliver at least the "minimum viable product (MVP) version" of the redesigned website planetaryhealthcheck.org by 24th September 2025 at the latest, as well as a finalized redesign by 31st October 2025. Each applicant develops one or more rough design concepts for this purpose. The application should additionally include references of previous projects. The design concepts should consider and harmonize with the scientific graphics developed by our graphics partner, GLOBAIA. The contractor may furthermore consider the design of the planetary health check itself. Reusing certain design elements from the previous version is possible, though not necessary. On this basis, a proposal is selected that is finally implemented by the contractor.

Given a final product that satisfies our requirements and a positive collaboration experience, we aim for a long-term collaboration to further develop and maintain the website beyond this date.

2.1 Server Management

The applicant shall propose a hosting option for the redesigned website on the server of an external hosting service. The provider shall register the domain and install the preferred content management system themselves. The provider is free in their choice of content management system, but commonly used, open content management systems are preferred. The currently used content management system is Storyblok. The hosting must be set up in a way that it could be transferred to the PIK or a third party with minimum effort. The server management of the website (incl. of hosting, support, and maintenance) for the site until and including 31st December 2027 is included in this tender amount.

The server management should include:

- Maintenance & Support
- Unlimited setup and issuance of SSL certificates
- Monitoring of website accessibility
- Offsite backup
    - Daily differential backups to servers in external data center
    - Includes export & backup of databases
    - Backup retention time: 2 weeks
    - Period: 1st September 2025 to 31st December 2027

Optionally, the server management may be extended by a period of two years (i.e. 1st January 2028 until 31st December 2029). The applicant shall indicate an offer for this extended server management in their application (this additional offer can surpass the budget of the overall project).

2.2 Simplify Structure and Access to Information

The current website features 10+ sub-pages, five of which can be accessed directly through tabs on top of the landing page. While some information seems over-represented, other essential components are difficult to find. Given that our international reach is growing, we expect a rising demand in the utility and understandability of the website. Suggestions for alternative site structures (an MVP as well as a final structure) are expected from the future winner within 14 days of commencing the tendering contract. The redesigned website is supposed to come online at the latest by 24th September 2025, in time for the publication of the second edition of the Planetary Health Check report. Until then, we expect at least the MVP version of the structure to be in place. This MVP version must provide access to the 2025 Planetary Health Check report, its executive summary in multiple languages, as well as its figures in a downloadable format. The final redesign should be in place by 31st October 2025. While the current layout of the website is optimized for only one report edition at a time, the redesigned website structure must accommodate multiple report editions (old report editions and their figures must remain accessible in downloadable formats via some form of archive).

2.3 Re-arrange and re-prioritize contents

Closely connected with a simplified structure is a re-arrangement and re-priorization of page contents. This includes highlighting essential content, for instance by linking it in several places across the website, creating new sub-pages for it, or by making it easily accessible directly on the landing page. While contents (such as files for download) belonging to previous report editions should still be easily accessible, the contents belonging to the newest edition, respectively (files for download as well as website-internal viewing options) should be front and center of the website. An important part of the website is that information is displayed at different levels of detail – offering a general understanding to those who are just learning about planetary boundaries, and give more technical information to those who are really interested. The structure of the site should allow this. In order to make the website easy to navigate, there should be a way to have an easily accessible overview of all pages and subpages (e.g. via a hamburger menu). Each sub-page should have the option to show a “read more”/ “related articles” segment at the bottom to guide visitors to another sub-page or an external link. Alongside with this ITT, we attach the PDF version of the Planetary Health Check report 2024. While the outline and layout of the Planetary Health Check report 2025 will slightly differ from the first edition, it still constitutes an important reference point.

On the landing page, the automated news ticker should be replaced by a section showing customized, manually curated content related to the PBScience Lab and its partners. This could be text, social media posts, embedded video or audio, etc. Using a e.g. a slider and/or arrows, one can navigate between several news pieces (total number of news items to be determined). The “News” sub-page should be used to show a chronological archive of past news. A new sub-page for learning materials should be created, which should be featured as a button on the landing page and which will summarize science communication content produced by the PBScience Lab and others (incl. links to external contents where possible and

useful). The purpose of such as sub-page is to feature all relevant learning content in one place, and to motivate visitors to come back to the site to continue to learn more.

2.4 User Experience und Usability

We envisage the new website being intuitive to navigate and user-friendly. Users should receive a positive overall impression when accessing the website and be able to find relevant content easily. The navigation should be logical and comprehensible. The contractor should develop a responsive web design that is also suitable for optimized usability on mobile devices. Selected fonts must be standard fonts, i.e. already pre-installed on the various user devices (Windows PC, macOS, Linux distributions, and mobile operating systems). Icons and pictograms may be used to facilitate navigation and orientation on the website. E.g., custom icons are already available for each planetary boundary, and our graphics partner GLOBAIA may create additional ones on-demand. The existing Planetary Health Check logo must be used. The choice of colors for the redesign of the website should harmonize with the scientific graphics developed by our graphics partner, GLOBAIA as well as with the existing Planetary Health Check logo. The colors must be web-safe. The applicant should include an estimate how much extra time and budget would be required to include the option to switch be-tween a light and a dark mode (imagery produced by our graphics partner can be provided in different color schemes, so the cost of image adjustment can be ignored in this calculation).

2.5 Accessibility

The design must be barrier-free based on BITV2.0/ Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG 2.1).

2.6 Develop, design and integrate interactive graphics and maps

We are looking for a developer team that has the capacity to design, develop and embed interactive graphics and maps, either bespoke or using tools such as Flourish, preferably in a vector-based format (e.g. .SVG). Improving the current method of displaying global map data, as well as updating the Planetary Boundaries diagram, are of the highest priority here. Improved timeline (X/Y-plot) displays and other animations are welcome as well. The required interactive graphics are mostly reproductions of figures generated by the graphic design studio GLOBAIA.

2.7 Facilitate easy editing of the website by PBScience Lab members

The contractor is expected to employ a commonly used content management system, which selected members of the scientific team shall be given access and basic instruction to. Moreover, the contractor should include in their application details on how/where to host the website, and how team members can propose changes to the website (e.g. via a website annotation tool). The contractor is obligated to share the access to the content management system with designated members of the PBScience Lab.

3. TARGET GROUPS

We explicitly do not want target group-oriented access to the website. Our audience is a global one, which means that the website must work across different cultural contexts. Nevertheless, our various target groups should be able to find their way around the new website quickly and easily and access the information that is relevant to them. The following target groups are relevant for our project:

1. Decision makers in politics, NGOs, and the private sector
2. Journalists/media representatives
3. The general public
4. (Potential) donors and funding bodies
5. The Scientific community

4. BUDGET

The budget has been calculated by PIK at € 50,000 gross. Offers above the available budget cannot be considered and will be excluded.

5. PROCUREMENT AND ALLOCATION CRITERIA

The services will be awarded as part of a public tender. Queries will be answered exclusively via the Vergabemarktplatz Brandenburg.

5.1 Minimum requirements for the contractor

The following minimum criteria are required for the submission of tenders. If one of these criteria is not met, the bid will be excluded.

- Proven expertise in the installation and customization of a content management system for modern websites with interactive graphic elements.
- Proven expertise in creating and embedding interactive graphics and maps.
- At least one reference of a project of comparable complexity.

5.2 Documents to be submitted

- signed offer letter (form 3.3)
- Detailed offer, with services broken down by item
- signed self-declaration on grounds for exclusion (form 4.1)
- signed agreement on compliance with the minimum requirements in accordance with the Brandenburg Public Procurement Act (form 5.3)
- presentation of the contractor and the project team
- Concept – at least one rough concept for the implementation of both the MVP and the final redesign must be submitted with the tender, which takes into account the abovementioned requirements and contains a schedule including milestones. For the timetable, the date for the publication of the MVP version of the redesigned website on

24.09.2025 and the date for the publication of the final redesigned website on 31.10.2025 must be considered in particular.

- Submission of at least four references. Proof of references is to be provided informally in the form of a self-declaration with a brief description of the reference, own contribution to the service, performance time, address and contact person of the respective client. A link to the references submitted is desirable.

5.3 Award criteria

The evaluation is based on the following criteria:

ASSESSMENT MATRIX		
Award criterion	**Assessment**	**Weighting in %**
Expertise and previous experience with comparable projects	The expertise of the applicant is assessed on the basis of the following criteria (based on references provided): • Experience in the visual presentation of scientific content (in collaboration with researchers) • Experience in the creation of modern, functional and stable websites • Experience in the design, implementation and embedding of interactive graphics and maps • Visual and functional quality of previous work	**40**
Concept draft	The concept draft is evaluated on the basis of the following criteria: • Consideration of the requirements mentioned under 2. • Feasibility of the time schedule, the milestone planning and the respective staff hours.	**40**
Price	Deviation in percent from the lowest price	**20**